

SENATE RESOLUTION 450

By Jackson

A RESOLUTION to acknowledge the receipt of a ceremonial sword from the Tennessee Society Sons of the American Revolution.

WHEREAS, the United States of America will celebrate her semi-quincentennial on July 4, 2026; and

WHEREAS, the Governor Archibald Roane Chapter, The Tennessee Society Sons of the American Revolution has enjoyed a long history of service to this State and its people through historic preservation, providing scholarships to students, raising awareness of the role of Tennesseans in the American Revolution; and

WHEREAS, this esteemed organization has enjoyed a special relationship to the Senate of Tennessee, operating a chapter at the Capitol, originally presided over by the Honorable Mark Norris, a Federal Judge and former Tennessee Senate Majority Leader, and proudly counting Senators from around the State as members through the years and annually presenting the Colors through a historic revolutionary war color guard; and

WHEREAS, the Governor Archibald Roane Chapter, The Tennessee Society Sons of the American Revolution has commissioned a Sword of State for presentation to the Senate to perpetually commemorate the 250th anniversary of the Declaration of Independence for the people, and the people's Senate of the State of Tennessee for all succeeding generations; and

WHEREAS, this sword is a modified replica of the sword presented to Tennessee's first governor, Governor John Sevier, for his action as Colonel during the pivotal Battle of Kings Mountain by the North Carolina Legislature, having a modified inscription appropriate to commemorate the 250th anniversary of the Declaration of Independence, and having been paid for by donations of patriotic Tennesseans and the Tennessee Society Sons of the American Revolution; and

WHEREAS, this sword is not intended to be displayed in a museum but to become an active piece of regalia of the Senate of Tennessee in the centuries' long tradition of legislative bodies in the western world, from the Manx Tynwald, to the South Carolina Senate, to the Massachusetts House of Representatives, to the United States Congress; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, that this body gratefully acknowledges the receipt of this sword, designates it as the "Sword of the Tennessee Senate," and authorizes and requires the Chief Clerk of the Senate to act as the custodian of the sword and to provide for its perpetual safekeeping and secure display in the Senate Chamber during the annual sessions of the Senate and in the Office of The Chief Clerk on other occasions.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that the Chief Clerk shall make recommendations to the Select Committee on Rules in the ensuing and future General Assemblies governing appropriate ceremony and active secure display of the "Sword of the Tennessee Senate" as a part of the regalia of the Senate, and its integration into the opening and closing of Sessions of the Senate and such other ceremonial purposes as may from time to time be required by resolution of this body.